

Project Start — First Night Session Logs

Date: February 24, 2026 (evening, Pacific time) **Original directory:** /Users/Bob/Dropbox/Docs/perstools/voting-research/ **Session IDs:** 8d2dede8 (planning) and f821ade9 (implementation)

Session 1: Planning (8d2dede8)

Started: 2026-02-25T03:17:29Z (~7:17 PM Pacific, Feb 24)

User (03:17:29Z)

I want to use the front end design plugin to create a website.

Assistant (03:17:33Z)

I'd be happy to help you create a website using the frontend design skill! Before I start planning, I need to understand what you're looking for.

[Asked: What kind of website? What topic?]

User (03:19:19Z)

- “The site will contain data for every state in the US; specifically, it will contain the requirements for people to register to vote.”
 - Topic: “Voting research”
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Assistant (03:19:23Z)

Great – a voter registration requirements site covering all 50 US states! Let me explore your existing codebase to understand what data and structure you already have.

[Explored repo – found it was empty]

Assistant (03:20:42Z)

The voting-research directory is currently empty, so we're starting fresh. Let me ask a few more questions to shape the design.

[Asked: Navigation style? Data points? Data source?]

User (03:21:25Z)

- Navigation: “Card grid” (selected the card grid wireframe with filter/search controls)
 - Data points: “Comprehensive”
 - Data source: “Research it for me”
-

Assistant (03:21:30Z)

Excellent choices! Let me now design the implementation plan based on everything we've discussed.

[Planned site architecture, data schema, and design specs]

Assistant (03:23:35Z)

[Read reference design styles and memory files, then wrote initial plan]

Plan described a single-page HTML app with: - `states-data.json` – Data for all 51 entries (50 states + DC) - `index.html` – Single-page app with embedded CSS and JS - Civic/minimalist design with navy (#1B3A5C) primary, green for positive, red for negative - Card grid layout with search/filter, expandable detail views

User (03:26:23Z)

I would like this site to be built using the eleventy static site generator. I also want the per-state data to include information about the availability of mail-in voting. The json structure of the data you've described lends itself well to eleventy's global data feature.

Assistant (03:26:27Z)

Great feedback! Let me research Eleventy's patterns and update the plan accordingly.

[Explored user's existing Eleventy projects (eleventy-base-blog) for patterns]

Assistant (03:27:41Z)

[Rewrote plan for Eleventy-based site]

Updated plan included: - `_data/states.json` (global data), Nunjucks templates, `public/` static assets - `mailInVoting` field with `available` boolean + `details` string - Server-side rendered cards with `{% for state in states %}` loop - Client-side filtering only (no DOM creation)

Assistant (03:28:14Z)

[Asked: Should each state have its own dedicated page, or just the card grid?]

User (03:28:30Z)

- “Card grid + state pages” (Grid page links to individual state detail pages via Eleventy pagination)
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Assistant (03:28:32Z)

[Updated plan to add `content/states.njk` pagination template and `_includes/layouts/state.njk`]

User (03:31:21Z)

The site should be responsive, working equally well on phones as on laptop and desktop screens, taking full advantage of the screen real estate available.

Assistant (03:31:24Z)

[Added detailed responsive breakpoints to plan]

- **< 640px (phone):** Single column, stacked badges, vertical controls
 - **640px-1024px (tablet):** 2-column grid, inline filters
 - **> 1024px (desktop):** 3-4 column grid, two-column state detail with sidebar
 - Touch-friendly tap targets (min 44px), fluid containers
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User (03:31:50Z)

[Approved plan and moved to implementation]

Session 2: Implementation (f821ade9)

Started: 2026-02-25T03:31:50Z (~7:31 PM Pacific, Feb 24)

User (03:31:50Z)

Implement the following plan:

[Pasted the full plan from Session 1 covering project structure, all 5 implementation steps]

Assistant (03:31:54Z — 03:38:28Z)

[Built the entire project]

1. Scaffolded Eleventy project (package.json, eleventy.config.js)
 2. Created `_data/states.json` with all 51 entries (researched voter registration data)
 3. Created all templates (base.njk, state.njk, state-card.njk, index.njk, states.njk)
 4. Created CSS (civic minimalist design) and JS (search/filter)
 5. Built successfully: 52 HTML files (1 home + 51 state pages)
 6. Added .gitignore
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User (03:40:00Z)

I'm seeing things like this in the interface:

✓ Online

Assistant (03:40:03Z — 03:40:26Z)

The HTML entities aren't being rendered as characters because Nunjucks is escaping them. Replaced HTML entities with literal Unicode characters (✓ and ✕) which don't need | safe.

User (03:41:34Z)

Is there research on the forms of ID acceptable for registration in each state?

Assistant (03:41:39Z)

Not really – the toRegister field is pretty shallow right now. Nearly every state just says “Driver’s license number or last 4 of SSN” with minor variations. It doesn’t cover real differences like:

- States requiring **proof of citizenship** documents (AZ, KS)
 - **Documentary proof of citizenship** laws vs. attestation only
 - Specific **alternative IDs** accepted
 - Whether **state ID cards** (non-driver) are accepted
 - States accepting **tribal IDs**, student IDs, or other non-standard documents
 - **Naturalized citizen** considerations
 - **Proof of residency** requirements
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User (03:42:10Z)

Yes, research and expand them

Assistant (03:42:14Z — 03:55:20Z)

[Performed extensive web research across multiple sources, then updated all 51 entries]

All 51 entries now have expanded toRegister fields covering: - Primary ID numbers needed - Fallback options (no DL or SSN) - Documentary proof of citizenship where required (AZ, KS, NH, WY, OH at BMV) - Proof of residency requirements - Special IDs accepted (tribal, student, military) - Naturalized citizen considerations - Notable state quirks (VA’s mandatory full SSN, IA’s 5-digit SSN, ND’s no-registration system, AZ’s federal-only voter bifurcation)

User (03:53:42Z)

What is taking so long?

Assistant (03:53:49Z)

Sorry - I was going to manually rewrite the whole 63KB file. Let me use a script instead, which will be much faster.

[Used Python script to update all 51 entries programmatically]

User (03:56:33Z)

I want to have a distinction between states where Mail-In Voting with no excuse required and those states with an excuse required.

Assistant (03:56:38Z — 03:57:40Z)

Added noExcuseRequired boolean to mailInVoting for all 51 entries. Updated badges: - Green: “✓ No-Excuse Mail-In” - Red: “● Excuse Required” - Added two filter buttons: “No-Excuse Mail-In” and “All Mail-In” - 40 no-excuse states, 11 excuse-required (AL, IN, KY, LA, MS, MO, NH, SC, TN, TX, WV)

User (03:58:27Z)

The red “Excuse Required” should be “Excuse Required Mail-In”

Assistant (03:58:31Z)

Done. Updated badge text on both card grid and state detail pages.

User (03:59:44Z)

On the home page, the “More details +” is not necessary, and all of those details should be displayed by default.

Assistant (03:59:52Z — 04:00:08Z)

Removed expand/collapse functionality. Cards now show all details (ID to Vote, Early Voting, Mail-In Voting) directly. Cleaned up unused CSS and JS.

User (04:03:33Z)

The state boxes for each state should be a bit bolder and use a slightly larger font size. And the site heading should be more prominent.

Assistant (04:03:37Z — 04:03:59Z)

- Site header: Larger (1.5rem), heavier weight (800), more padding
 - State cards: Thicker left border (5px), stronger shadow, more padding, base font 0.95rem
 - Card titles: 1.35rem, bolder (700)
 - Badges and labels: larger, bolder
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User (04:04:17Z)

The site title should be US Voter Registration and Voting Requirements

Assistant (04:04:21Z)

Updated site title in metadata.js, index.njk, and states.njk.

User (04:04:52Z)

The number of states matching the filter should be far more prominent.

Assistant (04:04:56Z)

Result count now large (1.3rem), bold, navy-colored, with the number itself even larger (1.6rem).

User (04:05:10Z)

Why are there 51 states noted and not 50?

Assistant (04:05:14Z)

Because the data includes all 50 states plus Washington DC. Updated display to read “Showing 51 of 51 (50 states + DC)”.

User (04:06:35Z)

I would like to see each state info on the home page fully enclosed in a visible border.

Assistant (04:06:40Z)

Added visible border on all four sides (light gray) with thicker navy accent on the left.

User (04:10:32Z)

The Excuse Required Mail-In should be treated similarly to Same Day, using an x and gray color.

Assistant (04:10:36Z)

“Excuse Required Mail-In” now uses gray background with ✕, matching other “no” badges.

User (04:33:45Z)

/exit

End of first night sessions.